In this session we defined a method in the irb session and then used it. Note that the irb session handles indent and outdent automatically. Also that the method definition returns the symbol name of the method, but the method call prints items and returns nil.

Also, when in the middle of editing something over multiple lines, such as the internals of the method definition and even the arithmetic expression that is split over multiple lines, pressing the up and down arrows will move you through that expression to allow you to edit across lines until the expression is complete. If you are not in the middle of a multi-line expression, pressing the up or down arrows will move you through the command history.

A great use of irb is experimenting with code you've already written. Perhaps you want to track down a bug, or maybe you just want to play. If you load your program into irb, you can then create instances of the classes it defines and invoke its methods. For example, the file code/irb/fibbonacci_sequence.rb contains the following method definition:

irb/fibonacci_sequence.rb

```
def fibonacci_sequence
  Enumerator.new do |generator|
    i1, i2 = 1, 1
    loop do
      generator.yield i1
      i1, i2 = i2, i1 + i2
    end
  end
end
```

We can load this into irb and play with the method:

```
irb(main):001:0> load("code/irb/fibonacci_sequence.rb")
=> true
irb(main):002:0> fibonacci_sequence.first(10)
=> [1, 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13, 21, 34, 55]
```

In this example, we use load, rather than require, to include the file in our session. We do this as a matter of practice: load allows us to load the same file multiple times, so if we find a bug and edit the file, we could reload it into our irb session.

Navigating irb

From the irb prompt if you are not in the middle of typing a multi-line expression, pressing the up-arrow will move you through your command history, showing the previous command, then the one before that and so on. The down-arrow will move you forward in the history once you have started backward. The command history is persisted between sessions.

Unlike the way your shell might be set up, the up-arrow does not act as a partial search, if you type a character and then the up-arrow, your typing will be replaced by the entire previous command regardless of whether the character you typed is the beginning of the previous command. By default, irb stores 1000 commands in its history, this amount can be configured.

If you are in the middle of an expression, then pressing the arrow keys will move you through that expression, allowing you to edit the expression before it is evaluated. This is relatively hard to demonstrate in a static book, but if you open up irb and type def foo then press return, then type 1 + 1 then press return, then an up arrow will allow you to navigate to change the